Week 5: Ship a Vertical Slice

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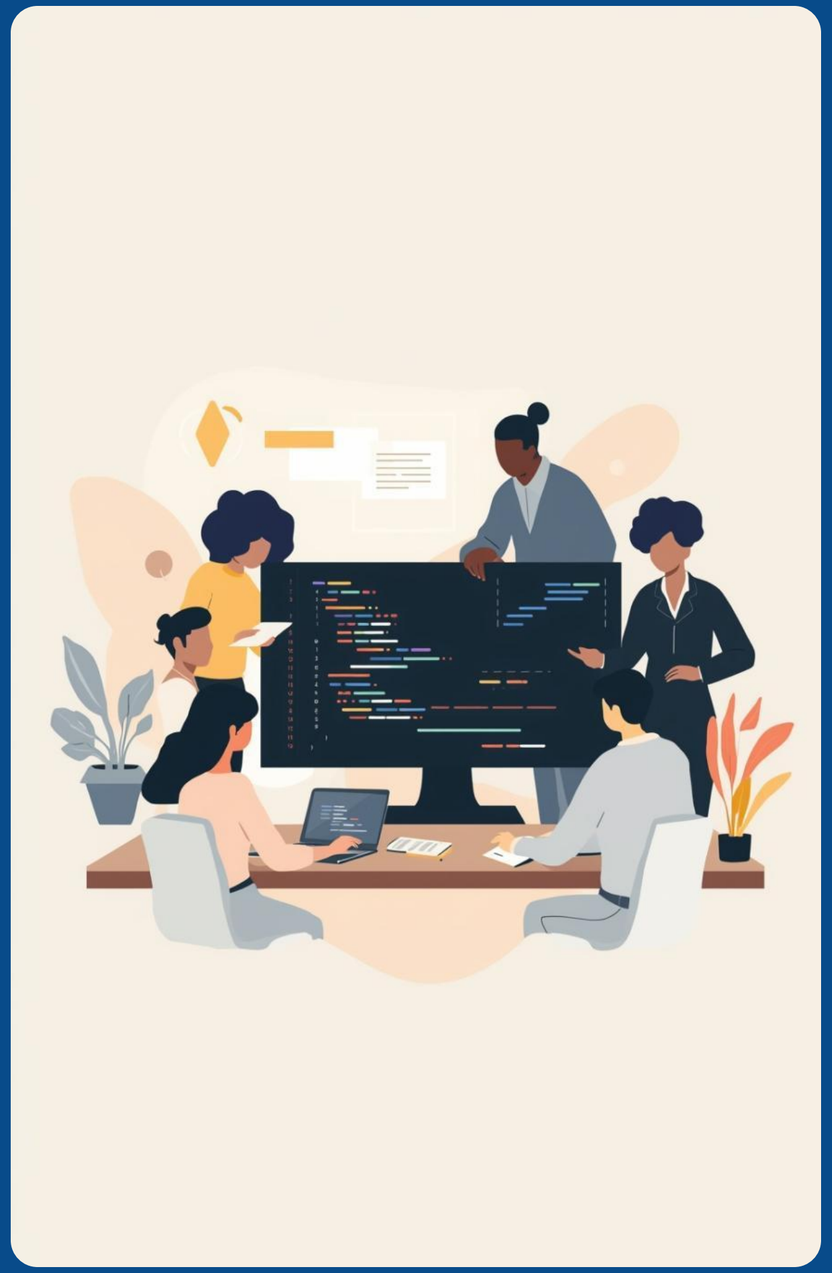
Capstone Design



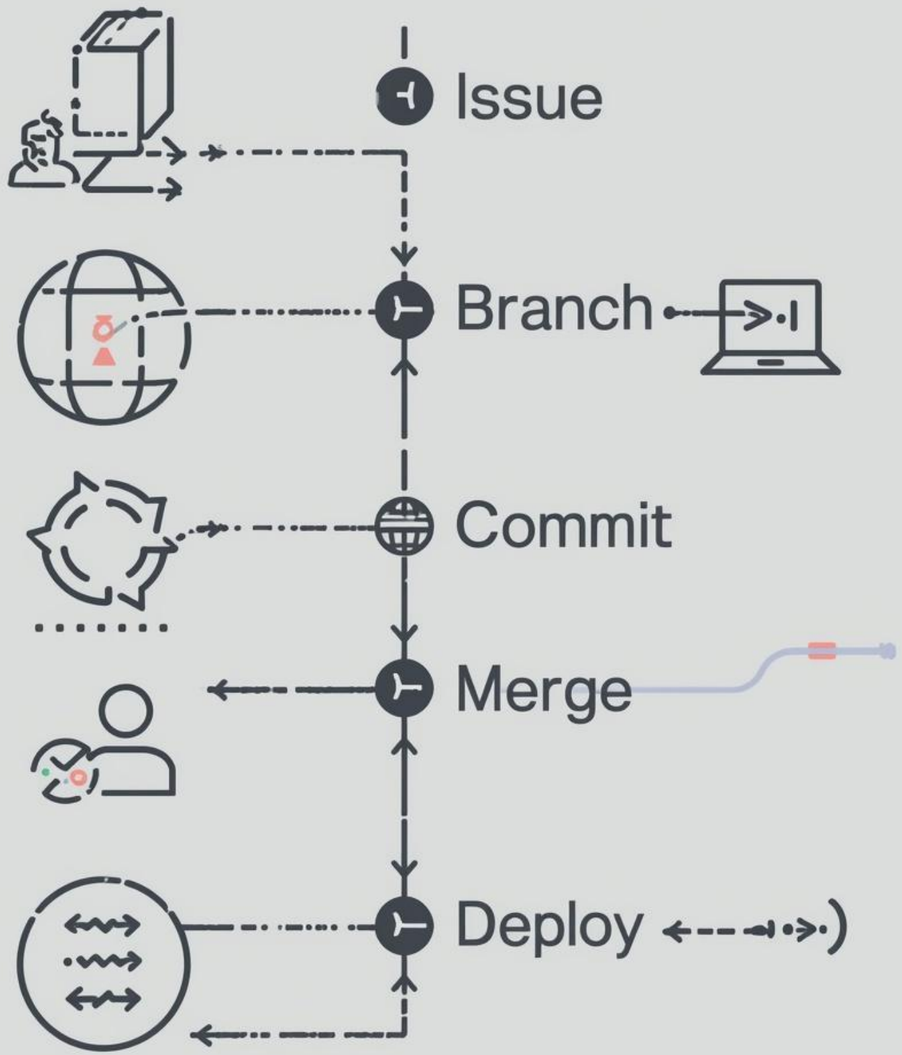
Today's Winning Workflow

By the end of class, your team should have:

- 1 Issue
- 1 branch
- 1 PR
- 1 review
- 1 check/CI result
- 1 demo or deploy link

The Workflow Simplified

A streamlined workflow consists of **Issue**, **Branch**, **Commit**, **Pull Request**, **Merge**, and **Deploy**. This clear process ensures efficiency and repeatability, enabling teams to deliver high-quality software reliably.



Understanding Vertical Slices

A vertical slice = one small feature that works end-to-end

- one form submits
- one page loads data
- one action saves correctly
- one user flow can be demonstrated

Not a vertical slice

- “worked on backend”
- “did UI”
- “fixed stuff”
- “made progress”

Aggressive Scope Cutting Strategies

Cut scope aggressively

- Choose the smallest useful thing
- One PR, one clear purpose
- Ugly but working beats ambitious and broken
- If blocked, simplify again

Aggressive Scope Cutting

veter cininersion ears.

Good Issue = Clear Target

A good Issue includes:

- **What: Clearly state the problem or task at hand.**
- **Why: Explain the purpose or reason behind the issue.**
- **Owner: Identify who is responsible for addressing the issue.**
- **Definition of Done: Specify the criteria that will determine when the issue is considered complete.**

Example DoD:

- **All code is reviewed and approved.**
- **Tests have been conducted and passed.**
- **Documentation is updated.**
- **Stakeholder feedback is incorporated.**

Good PR = Proof

01

What Changed

A good PR explains the changes made.

02

Why

Clarify the reasons behind the changes conducted.

03

How Tested

Include detailed information on testing procedures.

04

Evidence Exists

Link the issue and provide relevant documentation.

Continuous Integration Explained Simply

CI = automatic checks that run when you push code

Examples:

- app builds
- tests run
- lint/check script runs

Why it matters

- catches problems early
- makes quality visible
- helps demos be less chaotic

Continuous Integration

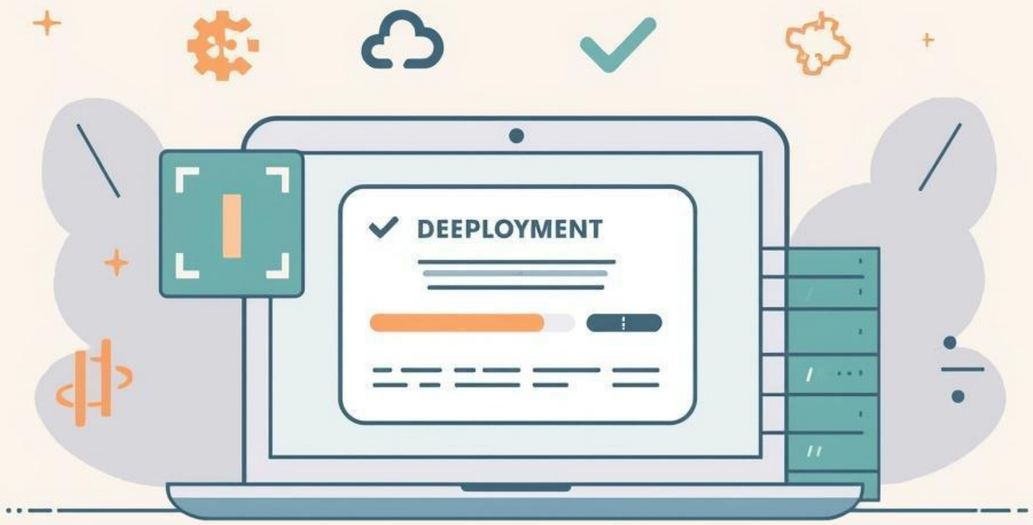
Deploying Your Vertical Slice

Deploy v0 means:

- your slice can be shown outside your laptop
- it is clickable, viewable, or watchable
- it has a backup plan if live demo fails

Acceptable evidence

- live URL
- short demo video
- deploy log or screenshot
- setup note in /docs



Today's Updates: GitHub and Sprint Packet

In GitHub

- Sprint Packet issue
- vertical-slice Issue
- board status
- PR
- review comment
- CI/check evidence

In the Sprint Packet

- demo link
- 3-bullet demo script
- backup plan
- shipped / broke / next / risks

Evidence Rule: Link Everything

If it isn't linked, it didn't happen

- Good receipts:
- PR link
- Issue link
- review comment
- CI run
- screenshot/video

Bad receipts:

- "I worked on it"
- "we discussed it"
- "almost done"

Common Mistakes to Avoid

01

Main

Avoid working on the main branch directly.

02

Starting

Avoid starting without a clear issue defined first.

03

How Tested

Avoid omitting a section detailing how tests were done.

04

Huge PRs

Avoid creating large pull requests that confuse reviewers.

05

Owner

Avoid missing an assigned owner for each task.

06

Receipts

Avoid missing evidence links or documentation for tasks.

In-Class Build Checklist

Every team must have:

- Issue created
- branch created
- PR opened
- owner assigned
- DoD written

Before the end of class:

- review comment posted
- checks run
- demo/deploy link ready

Exit Ticket: Evidence Submission

Complete your exit ticket by providing links for your **issue**, **PR**, **check or CI**, and **demo or deploy**. Remember, no links mean no workshop completion and success relies on evidence.

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Success

Embrace the journey and grow